

SPANISH VERB CONJUGATIONS - TENER (TO HAVE)

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PRESENT SIMPLE ⚠ Irregular:

Yo **tengo** - I have

Tú tienes - You have

Él/Ella tiene - He/She has

Nosotros tenemos - We have

Vosotros tenéis - You all have (Spain)

Ellos tienen - They have

PAST SIMPLE (Preterite) ⚠ Irregular Stem:

Yo **tuve** - I had / I got

Tú **tuviste** - You had / You got

Él/Ella tuvo - He/She had / He/She got

Nosotros tuvimos - We had / We got

Vosotros tuvisteis - You all had / You all got (Spain)

Ellos tuvieron - They had / They got

FUTURE SIMPLE ⚠ Irregular Stem:

Yo **tendré** - I will have

Tú tendrás - You will have

Él/Ella tendrá - He/She will have

Nosotros tendremos - We will have

Vosotros tendréis - You all will have (Spain)

Ellos tendrán - They will have

PRESENT CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estoy teniendo** - I am having

Tú estás teniendo - You are having

Él/Ella **está teniendo** - He/She is having

Nosotros estamos teniendo - We are having

Vosotros **estáis teniendo** - You all are having (Spain)

Ellos están teniendo - They are having

⚠ ****Note****: *Tener* is rarely used in continuous forms for possession. Use simple present for possession: *Tengo un coche* (NOT ~~Estoy teniendo un coche~~). But it CAN be used for experiences: *Estoy teniendo un buen día.* (I'm having a good day.)

PAST CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estaba teniendo** - I was having

Tú estabas teniendo - You were having

Él/Ella **estaba teniendo** - He/She was having

Nosotros estábamos teniendo - We were having

Vosotros **estabais teniendo** - You all were having (Spain)

Ellos estaban teniendo - They were having

FUTURE CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estaré teniendo** - I will be having

Tú estarás teniendo - You will be having

Él/Ella **estará teniendo** - He/She will be having

Nosotros estaremos teniendo - We will be having

Vosotros estaréis teniendo - You all will be having (Spain)

Ellos estarán teniendo - They will be having

PRESENT PERFECT:

Yo **he tenido** - I have had

Tú has tenido - You have had

Él/**Ella ha tenido** - He/She has had

Nosotros hemos tenido - We have had

Vosotros habéis tenido - You all have had (Spain)

Ellos han tenido - They have had

PAST PERFECT:

Yo **había tenido** - I had had

Tú habías tenido - You had had

Él/**Ella había tenido** - He/She had had

Nosotros habíamos tenido - We had had

Vosotros habíais tenido - You all had had (Spain)

Ellos habían tenido - They had had

FUTURE PERFECT:

Yo **habré tenido** - I will have had

Tú habrás tenido - You will have had

Él/Ella habrá tenido - He/She will have had

Nosotros habremos tenido - We will have had

Vosotros habréis tenido - You all will have had (Spain)

Ellos habrán tenido - They will have had

CONDITIONAL ⚠ Irregular Stem:

Yo **tendría** - I would have

Tú tendrías - You would have

Él/Ella **tendría** - He/She would have

Nosotros tendríamos - We would have

Vosotros tendríais - You all would have (Spain)

Ellos tendrían - They would have

COULD HAVE (PODER + HABER + PARTICIPLE):

Yo podría haber + participio - I could have + past participle

Tú podrías haber + participio - You could have...

*(Example: **Podría haberlo hecho** = I could have done it)*

SHOULD HAVE (DEBER + HABER + PARTICIPLE):

Yo debería haber + participio - I should have + past participle

Tú deberías haber + participio - You should have...

*(**Example: Deberías haberlo hecho = You should have done it**)*

EXAMPLE SENTENCES:

- Podría tener más paciencia con mis hijos.

(I could have more patience with my children.)

- Debería tener más cuidado al conducir.

(I should be more careful when driving.)

- Tengo que tener listo el informe para mañana. (I have to have the report ready for tomorrow.)

⚠️ ****Important Notes on "Tener"**:**

◆ ****Highly Irregular Verb — Multiple Patterns**:**

Tener is one of the most irregular and essential verbs in Spanish.

Tense	Irregularity	Example
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Present	e→ie stem change + irregular yo	*tengo, tienes, tiene, tienen*
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Preterite	Irregular stem *tuv-*	*tuve, tuviste, tuvo, tuvieron*
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Future/Conditional	Irregular stem *tendr-*	*tendré, tendría*
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Present Subjunctive	Based on *yo tengo*	*tenga, tengas, tenga...*
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! ****Critical Preterite Note**:**

Él/Ella tuvo has ****NO accent**** (unlike regular -er/-ir verbs like *comió*).

◆ ****Two Main Meanings**:**

Meaning	Example	Translation
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To Have (possession)	*Tengo un coche.*	I have a car.
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To Be (with age, sensations)	*Tengo 25 años.*	I am 25 years old.
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💡 ****Key Tip**:** In Spanish, *tener* expresses age, hunger, thirst, and other states that English uses "to be" for.

◆ ****Key Distinction: Preterite vs. Imperfect****:

| Tense | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| ****Imperfect (*tenía*)**** | Had (ongoing state) | *Tenía un coche.* (I had a car.) |

| ****Preterite (*tuve*)**** | Got / Received (specific moment) | *Tuve un coche nuevo.* (I got a new car.) |

◆ ****Regular Forms**** :

- Past Participle: *tenido*

- Gerund: *teniendo*

- Imperfect: *tenía, tenías, tenía...*

 ****Common Expressions with "Tener"**** (Idiomatic uses where Spanish uses *tener* but English uses *to be*):

| Expression | Literal | Actual Meaning |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *tener hambre* | to have hunger | to be hungry |

| *tener sed* | to have thirst | to be thirsty |

| *tener frío/calor* | to have cold/heat | to be cold/hot |

| *tener sueño* | to have sleepiness | to be sleepy |

| *tener miedo* | to have fear | to be afraid |

| *tener razón* | to have reason | to be right |

| *tener prisa* | to have hurry | to be in a hurry |

| *tener suerte* | to have luck | to be lucky |

| *tener ... años* | to have ... years | to be ... years old |

 ****Essential Structures with "Tener"**:**

| Structure | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *tener + noun* | to have something | *Tengo un libro.* |

| *tener que + infinitive* | to have to do something | *Tengo que estudiar.* |

| *tener + past participle* | to have something done (resultative) | *Tengo escrito el informe.* |

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| *tener ganas de + infinitive* | to feel like doing something | *Tengo ganas de comer.* |



****Key Tip**:** *Tener que* is the most common way to express obligation in Spanish!

 ****Verbs Derived from "Tener"** (follow same irregular patterns):**

| Verb | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *contener* | to contain | *La caja contiene libros.* |

| *detener* | to stop/detain | *Detén el coche.* |

| *mantener* | to maintain | *Mantén la calma.* |

| *obtener* | to obtain | *Obtuve el permiso.* |

| *retener* | to retain | *Retén la información.* |

| *sostener* | to support/sustain | *Sostén mi mano.* |



****Ready for the next verb!**** Just say: ****Next verb: [verb]**** 